

HOW TO PLANT

To plant your Western Red Cedar, it's best to find a spot that gets partial shade. this tree doesn't tolerate the hot summer sun well until they're older, so they're great for planting under the cover of other trees

Western Red Cedar can grow up to 250 feet tall and about 30 ft wide. So if you can, plant these spaced about 20-25 ft away from buildings, power lines, utilities, and streets to secure a long life.

Dig a hole large enough to fit the roots without burying the tree's small trunk. Avoid the errors shown on the right. *Graphics by Department of Natural Resources.* After planting, pad down the soil with your hands to fill in any air holes where

For the first year or two, water during the dry season if it's exposed to a lot of sunlight or the ground gets dry. Otherwise, these trees are great at self-caring, as they are filled with fungal and bacterial resistance.

CONTACT US

Email: Info@rutaverde.org
Socials: [@rutaverdesustainability](https://www.instagram.com/rutaverdesustainability)



Too shallow



Turned up roots



Tangled roots



Too deep



Rock



Air pocket

ABOUT

Ruta Verde Sustainability is a 501(c)3 nonprofit focused on the research of Indigenous sustainable practices such as Agroforestry, which mixes agricultural crops with native trees and shrubs to provide environmental and economic benefits:

ENHANCED BIODIVERSITY

Different plants invite different beneficial insects, bacteria, and fungi which build healthy soils

PROTECT WATER

Trees and plants with larger roots and increased biomass helps to hold and cleanse water.

HEALTHIER FOOD

Increased water retention and perennial root systems provide food that is more nutritious and more resilient

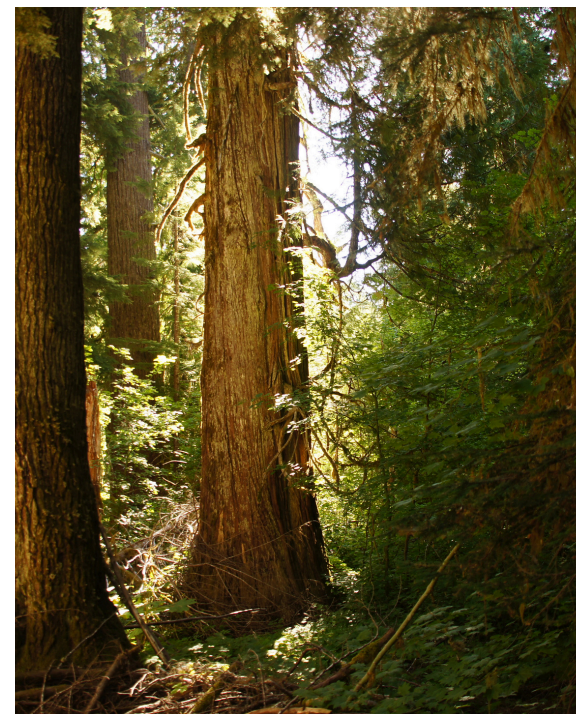
Agroforestry is one of the many techniques Indigenous people developed over centuries of interacting with the local environment. By learning and implementing these lessons into our modern practices we can create healthy and sustainable futures. If you'd like to support our work, check out our website, rutaverde.org



Gracias



WESTERN RED CEDAR (THUJA PLICATA)



Western Red Cedar is an important tree to PNW culture with every part of the tree being useful for human needs. These plants like to grow in shady moist places which helps the tree to develop resistances to infections and rot. This makes it a great tree for building homes and medicine, which is why Indigenous people referred to it as "Tree of Life"

TREE FACTS

Scientific name: Thuja plicata

Family: Cupressaceae

Class: Pinopsida

Genus: Thuja

Division: Pinophyta

Kingdom: Plantae

Growth rate: 2' per year



SEED HARVESTING

Western Red Cedar cones are small and best harvested in the late fall, October or November. Seeds are ready about a month after the cones start to open. To grow the seeds, the freezing or stratification of seeds is not necessary. Plant the seeds in moist soil.

FUN FACTS

Referred to as Tree of life, this plant sustained the mind, body and soul as virtually every part of the tree was used in some aspect of life - longhouses, canoes, totem poles, baskets, clothing, ropes, cooking utensils, medicines, spiritual ceremonies, ceremonial masks, hats and capes.

Leaves of the tree are also burned during prayers and are believed to remove negative energies.

ROLE IN THE FOREST

This tree helps is able to to grow in shaded areas and moist soils where other trees might not do as well. This tree's leaves are also a delicacy for wildlife, and young trees are often targeted by deer for food. Plant Sitka Spruce close to Wester Red Cedar to offer protection!

USES

The tree's resistant to decay makes it a great construction item. But there are other wonderful uses for the tree, for instance the branches are very flexible and have good tensile strength. They were stripped and used as strong cords for fishing line, rope cores, twine, and other purposes where bark cord was not strong enough or might fray.

At the right time of year, the bark of Western red cedars is easily removed from live trees in long strips. It would be harvested for use in making mats, rope and cordage, basketry, rain hats, clothing, and other soft goods. The harvesting of bark must be done with care because, if the tree is completely stripped, it will die.

Another popular use for the aromatic tree is to make essential oils through steam distillation of needles and twigs.

